

Rehan Ali Mirza

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Experience

University of Pennsylvania

Doctoral Researcher, Annenberg School for Communication

Philadelphia, PA

Aug 2025 – Present

- Use experimental and computational methods to study platform design, governance, and online discourse
- Current projects include a survey experiment on community moderation and an eight-dimensional discourse quality metric developed through a design-based supervised learning approach

Prosocial Design Network

Fellow

Remote

Apr 2025 – Apr 2026

- Facilitated expert working group sessions and co-authored report on researcher-practitioner collaboration to catalyze actionable platform-design research
- Led social media section of report mapping 30+ LLM-enabled tools for public discourse, surveying 25+ developers and stakeholders

Shorenstein Center, Harvard Kennedy School

Policy Researcher

Cambridge, MA

2023 – 2024

- Analyzed Facebook Papers for platform governance case studies and policy recommendations; developed voter education resources; engaged FCC, FTC, and Obama Foundation

L.E.K. Consulting

Strategy Consultant

London, UK

2017 – 2021

- Delivered quantitative analysis, market research, and strategic recommendations across 20+ commercial and public-sector projects
- Led workstreams involving financial modeling, survey analysis, large dataset analysis, and 60+ stakeholder interviews for senior client stakeholders

Projects

Integrity Institute

Tech Policy Tracker, Operational Lead

Remote

Aug 2024 – Present

- Developed public U.S. federal/state tech-legislation tracker with LLM-assisted summarization, thematic classification, and searchable front-end; built semi-automated Python pipeline using ML/NLP and APIs
- Produced supporting infrastructure including technical documentation, website analytics, user support workflows, and volunteer coordination processes for ongoing tracker maintenance

Trustible

AI Governance Consultant

Remote

Jul 2023 – Oct 2023

- Interviewed privacy professionals on AI governance readiness; synthesized findings into public-facing thought leadership and product-relevant insights

Selected Writing: Publications and reports in Tech Policy Press, Journalist's Resource, Shorenstein Center, Trustible, Media Manipulation Casebook, and Prosocial Design Network. Full list at rehanmirza.net

Education

University of Pennsylvania

Ph.D. in Communication, GPA: 4.0 (current)

Philadelphia, PA

Aug 2025 – Present

Advisor: Sandra González-Bailón | Center for Information Networks and Democracy

Harvard Kennedy School

Master in Public Policy

Cambridge, MA

May 2023

University College London

MSc Global Health and Development

London, UK

Sep 2016

University of Cambridge

BA Economics

Cambridge, UK

Jun 2014

Skills

Technical: Python, R, Stata, NLP/ML, LLM-assisted classification, API integration, GitHub, Qualtrics, Tableau

Methods: Experimental design, survey design, statistical modeling, content analysis, causal inference, qualitative interviews

Domains: Platform governance, trust and safety, information integrity, online discourse, AI governance, prosocial design